



The voice of India's people is changing as is the realm within which it operates. Even as media consumers become active media producers, India has to recognise that entrepreneurship is in its DNA. Tapping into a new woman's consciousness, investing in its R&D and revamping reservations are just some other ways in which every aspiration can become a new opportunity.

UNLEASHING AN ENTREPRENEURIAL mindset requires drive and a diploma. Indians need to become doers, not just dreamers.

The image of the lonely miser, cursed with riches that he can only stockpile but never spend, a person whose greed cuts him off from human contact, is one encountered in myth and fiction. Sometimes in reality, too. But true wealth is only partly measured in coin and paper, as important as those markers of success can be in the greater journey to significance.

"Misers mistake gold for good, whereas it is only a means of obtaining it," said François de la Rochefoucauld 350 years ago. Today, we say that this wealth is splendid only when it creates more affluence—and not simply for the miser, but for those around him too. Hand in glove with this material boon comes great social and relational capital.

It is the entrepreneur who most seems the antithesis of the skinflint. Rather than hoarding wealth, entrepreneurs try to generate more of it by using ingenuity to offer solutions that improve life, influencing others to do the same. With talent, persistence and luck, even initially modest efforts may turn a tidy profit. Ask Haldiram Agrawal, whose famous sweetshop, begun as a small venture in Bikaner 70 years ago, has grown into a snack-market leader.

This success requires many elements: technical, business savvy, yes, but also the ability to connect with others and cultivate trust among the employees who help bring an enterprise to life. It's also critical for entrepreneurs to take risks and "go beyond" conventional notions in search of opportunities and excellence. The

VIKRAM SHARMA

Tricks of the Trade

THE ABILITY TO CONNECT WITH OTHERS AND CULTIVATE TRUST AMONG EMPLOYEES HELP BRING AN ENTERPRISE TO LIFE.

